Impartial Analysis of Measure L

Bonds are financial instruments used to borrow money. Under the California Constitution, school districts may issue bonds if approved by at least 55 percent of voters within the boundaries of the district who are voting on a measure to authorize the issuance of bonds. The bonds are sold to the public and constitute a debt of the district. The principal and interest on the bonds are repaid by an annual property tax levy on all real property within the jurisdiction of the school district, calculated on the current assessed value of each property ("an *ad valorem* tax").

The Board of Trustees of the North Monterey County Unified School District (hereafter "the District") has placed Measure L on the ballot, proposing the sale of bonds in the amount not to exceed $40 million. The District's Tax Rate Statement, included in the voter information guide, which was mailed to voters of the District, reflects an estimate of the maximum property tax levies required to service the bonds.

In accordance with the law, proceeds from the sale of the bonds (i.e., funds generated by the bonds) may only be used for the specific purposes identified in the measure and listed in the voter information guide, including to upgrade, improve, construct and acquire school facilities and modernize and rehabilitate existing school facilities. The law prohibits the use of bond proceeds to pay for teacher and administrator salaries or other operational expenses. Bond proceeds can be used to pay staff time for work incidental to bond projects. Approval of the measure does not guarantee that all of the proposed projects of the District to be improved with bond proceeds will be funded beyond the local revenues generated by the measure.

As required by law, the District must follow certain accountability provisions to oversee the funds collected and expended, including the establishment of an independent Citizens' Oversight Committee, the annual completion of Performance and Financial Audits, and an annual report detailing proceeds received by the sale of the bonds and expenditures made, all requirements of which are reflected in the full text of measure.

The District's Tax Rate Statement provides the District's best estimate of the highest tax rate to be levied at approximately $32 per $100,000 of assessed property value per year. The final fiscal year in which the tax is anticipated to be collected is 2054.

A "Yes" vote on this measure is a vote in favor of the issuance of $40 million in general obligation bonds to be used for the purposes set forth in Measure L.

A "No" vote on this measure is a vote against the issuance of $40 million in general obligation bonds for the purposes set forth in Measure L.

Dated: August 14, 2026

Susan Blitch
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Received
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Monterey County Elections